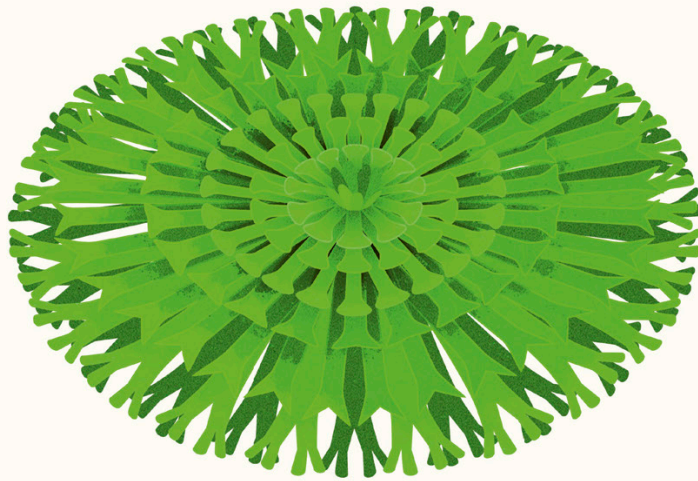


Spike moss

Raindrops begin to fall on the hot, sandy desert. Soon it is pouring down. The rain splashes a dried-up ball of dead leaves. Then something magical happens. The crisp, brown plant starts to uncurl, spreads out, and turns green. The plant is coming back to life!

This plant is a type of spike moss. Spike mosses are an ancient family of plants, and this particular species is also known as a dinosaur plant. When the ground becomes too dry, the dinosaur plant's leaves curl up and the plant shuts down. However, only a few hours after getting wet, it opens up again. Part of its secret is that its leaves can bend and roll up without breaking.



A dinosaur plant can lose 95 percent of its water and still survive. It can stay as a dry ball for years.